

ProjectSync Pro — Stripe Payment Setup Guide

This guide walks you through accepting payments for ProjectSync Pro tier using **Stripe**.

You have **TWO options** — choose based on your comfort level:

Option	Difficulty	Best For
A. Stripe Payment Links (No-Code)	★ Easy	Start immediately, no backend
B. Stripe Checkout + Edge Functions	Medium	Full integration, automated

Option A: Stripe Payment Links (Recommended to Start)

This is the **fastest way** to start accepting payments — literally 5 minutes, zero code.

Step 1: Create Stripe Account

1. Go to stripe.com
2. Sign up (free, no commitment)
3. You'll start in **Test Mode** (perfect for testing)

Step 2: Create a Product

1. In Stripe Dashboard, go to **Products** (left sidebar)
2. Click + **Add Product**
3. **Name:** ProjectSync Pro
4. **Description:** Unlimited projects, advanced analytics, priority support
5. Click **Save**

Step 3: Add Pricing

1. In your product, click + **Add Price**
2. **Pricing model:** Standard pricing
3. **Price:** \$3.00
4. **Billing period:** Monthly
5. Click **Save**
6. (Optional) Add yearly pricing:
 - Click + **Add Price** again
 - **Price:** \$24.00
 - **Billing period:** Yearly
 - Click **Save**

Step 4: Create Payment Link

1. Go to **Payment Links** (left sidebar)
2. Click **+ Create**
3. Select your **ProjectSync Pro** product
4. Choose the **Monthly** price
5. Click **Next**
6. **After payment:** Redirect to your Vercel URL: `https://your-projectsync.vercel.app/?payment=success`
7. Click **Create link**
8. **Copy the Payment Link URL** (looks like: `https://buy.stripe.com/test_abc123`)

Step 5: Paste Into Your Code

Open `stripe_integration.js` and replace:

```
PAYMENT_LINK_MONTHLY: 'https://buy.stripe.com/test_YOUR_MONTHLY_LINK',  
PAYMENT_LINK_YEARLY: 'https://buy.stripe.com/test_YOUR_YEARLY_LINK',
```

With your actual Payment Link URLs.

Step 6: Test It

1. Open your app
2. Click “Upgrade to Pro”
3. Click “Upgrade Monthly”
4. Use Stripe test card: 4242 4242 4242 4242
5. Any future date, any CVC, any ZIP
6.  Payment successful!

Step 7: Go Live (When Ready)

1. In Stripe Dashboard, toggle from **Test Mode** to **Live Mode**
2. Repeat Steps 2-4 in Live Mode
3. Update your Payment Link URLs in the code
4. Redeploy to Vercel

Option B: Full Stripe Integration (Automated)

This gives you **automated subscription management** — users are upgraded instantly, cancellations handled automatically, webhooks keep everything in sync.

Prerequisites

- Supabase CLI installed: `npm install -g supabase`
- Stripe account

Step 1: Set Up Stripe Products

Same as Option A, Steps 1-3. Note down the **Price IDs**:

- Monthly: price_1ABC...
- Yearly: price_1DEF...

Step 2: Configure Edge Function Secrets

In Supabase Dashboard → **Edge Functions** → **Secrets**, add:

```
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY      = sk_test_...
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET  = whsec_... (we'll get this in Step 5)
SUPABASE_URL           = https://your-project.supabase.co
SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY = eyJ... (from Settings > API)
```

Step 3: Deploy the Checkout Edge Function

```
# In your project folder, create the function structure
mkdir -p supabase/functions/create-checkout

# Copy stripe_edge_function.js to supabase/functions/create-checkout/index.ts
# (Rename .js to .ts for TypeScript)

# Deploy
supabase functions deploy create-checkout
```

Step 4: Deploy the Webhook Edge Function

```
mkdir -p supabase/functions/stripe-webhook

# Copy stripe_webhook_edge.js to supabase/functions/stripe-webhook/index.ts

# Deploy with --no-verify-jwt (webhooks don't use JWT)
supabase functions deploy stripe-webhook --no-verify-jwt
```

Step 5: Configure Stripe Webhook

1. In Stripe Dashboard → **Developers** → **Webhooks**
2. Click + **Add endpoint**
3. **Endpoint URL:** `https://your-project.supabase.co/functions/v1/stripe-webhook`
4. Select events:
 - `checkout.session.completed`
 - `customer.subscription.updated`
 - `customer.subscription.deleted`
 - `invoice.payment_failed`
5. Click **Add endpoint**
6. Copy the **Signing secret** (`whsec_...`)
7. Add it to Supabase Edge Function Secrets as `STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET`

Step 6: Update Frontend Code

In `stripe_integration.js`, replace:

```
const STRIPE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY = 'pk_test_YOUR_PUBLISHABLE_KEY_HERE';
const STRIPE_PRICE_ID = 'price_YOUR_MONTHLY_PRICE_ID';
const STRIPE_PRICE_ID_YEARLY = 'price_YOUR_YEARLY_PRICE_ID';
```

Get your Publishable Key from Stripe Dashboard → **Developers** → **API Keys**.

Step 7: Update Supabase SQL

Run the updated supabase_setup.sql (it now includes the subscriptions table and is_pro field).

Step 8: Test the Full Flow

1. Open your app → Click “Upgrade to Pro”
2. Click “Upgrade Monthly” → Redirects to Stripe Checkout
3. Pay with test card 4242 4242 4242 4242
4. Redirected back to your app with ?payment=success
5. Check Supabase → profiles table → is_pro should be true
6. Check subscriptions table → new row with status: active

🎓 Student Discount Strategy

Stripe doesn’t have a built-in “student discount” feature, but you can implement it:

Method 1: Student Pricing Tier

Create a separate product:

- **Name:** ProjectSync Pro — Student
- **Price:** \$1.50/month or \$12/year (50% off)
- **Verification:** Manual (ask for .edu email or student ID via email)

Method 2: Coupon Codes

1. In Stripe Dashboard → **Products** → **Coupons**
2. Create coupon: STUDENT50 → 50% off, recurring
3. Share code with verified students
4. Students enter code at checkout

Method 3: Email Domain Verification (Automated)

In your Edge Function, check if email ends with .edu:

```
const isStudent = email.endsWith('.edu') || email.endsWith('.ac.uk');
const priceId = isStudent ? STUDENT_PRICE_ID : REGULAR_PRICE_ID;
```

📊 Monitoring Your Revenue

Metric	Where to Find
Monthly Revenue	Stripe Dashboard → Home
Active Subscriptions	Stripe Dashboard → Subscriptions
Churn Rate	Stripe Dashboard → Reports
Failed Payments	Stripe Dashboard → Invoices

🔴 Important Notes

1. **Test Mode vs Live Mode:** Always test in Test Mode first. Switch to Live Mode only when ready.
2. **PCI Compliance:** Using Stripe Checkout or Payment Links means Stripe handles PCI compliance — you're fully compliant automatically.
3. **Taxes:** Stripe Tax can auto-calculate VAT/GST. Enable in Dashboard → Tax.
4. **Refunds:** Process refunds directly in Stripe Dashboard.
5. **Payouts:** Stripe pays out to your bank account on a 7-day rolling basis (or 2-day for established accounts).

💰 Pricing Psychology for Students

Strategy	Why It Works
\$3/month vs \$24/year	Yearly feels like a bigger commitment but saves money
"Less than a coffee per month"	Anchors to familiar spending
50% student discount	Creates exclusivity, encourages sign-ups
Free trial (7-14 days)	Reduces friction, lets users experience value first

Next Steps

1. ✅ Set up Stripe Payment Links (5 min)
2. ✅ Test with test card
3. ✅ Share with 5 classmates for beta testing
4. ✅ Collect feedback on pricing
5. ✅ Switch to Live Mode when ready
6. ✅ Apply to Y Combinator / local accelerators with revenue numbers

Built with  by a student, for students worldwide.